

Technical Report Summary: WannaCry Detonation

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- **Report ID:** 2026-05-06-WC-01
- **Classification:** TLP:CLEAR
- **Subject:** WannaCry Ransomware Detonation & Tooling Exhaustion Analysis

Executive Summary

On May 6, 2026, an authorised detonation of a suspected WannaCry ransomware payload was conducted within an airgapped Windows 10 virtual environment. Initial execution attempts resulted in catastrophic Out-Of-Memory (OOM) kernel panics and EFI boot partition corruption. Forensic analysis determined that the massive volume of I/O events generated by the payload caused the primary behavioural monitoring tool (Process Monitor) to exhaust available virtual memory and lock the storage drive. Subsequent troubleshooting, culminating in a "Bare Detonation" (execution without kernel-level logging), allowed the payload to successfully unpack, drop ransom notes, and force an emergency Windows Safe Mode reboot, effectively interrupting the malware's external C2 beaconing phase.

List of Affected Entities

- **Internal Source (Assigned):** 192.168.134.128 (Assigned to Virtual Machine Host: DESKTOP-KHTFPG0)
- **Target Identity:** Windows 10 Virtual Environment (User: Analyst)
- **Attacker IP:** N/A (Execution interrupted prior to external connection)
- **Identity:** Analyst (Local Administrator Account)
- **VPN Gateway:** None (Isolated Host-Only Network VMnet1)
- **External Actor:** WannaCry / WannaCryptor Ransomware (SHA256: C34AF1F1F238747D6839CE6857138E97D722443C4E2A794C072C236228CEAA07)

Technical Findings & Troubleshooting Chronology

Execution Attempt 1 (Baseline): Payload initiated via user interaction. The malware spawned cmd.exe to delete volume shadow copies. The rapid file encryption sequence overwhelmed Process Monitor (Procmon), exhausting the 4GB of allocated VM RAM in milliseconds. This resulted in a hard system crash and an "Operating System Not Found" EFI error.

Execution Attempt 2 (Tool Tuning): The environment was restored. To mitigate RAM exhaustion, Procmon was aggressively tuned:

- A strict inclusion filter was applied: Process Name -> is -> wannacry.exe -> Include.
- Memory optimisation was enabled via the Filter menu by selecting *Drop Filtered Events*.
- **Result:** Despite memory optimisation, the sheer volume of disk I/O requests generated by the ransomware caused a storage bottleneck, resulting in a secondary fatal EFI Network Timeout crash.

Execution Attempt 3 (Bare Detonation): The environment was restored. Procmon was disabled entirely to prevent tool-induced instability. Process Explorer and Wireshark remained active.

- **Result:** The detonation succeeded without corrupting the virtual disk. The aggressive encryption and system modification triggered a native Windows kernel panic, forcing the host into an emergency Safe Mode reboot.

Host Indicators (IoCs): Upon booting into Safe Mode, the following artefacts were observed on the desktop:

- Ransom instructions: @Please_Read_Me.txt
- Decryptor executable: @WanaDecryptor@.exe

- Bitcoin Wallet Address: 12t9YDPgwueZ9NyMgw519p7AA8isjr6SMw

Network Activity: Network captures on the isolated interface (ens33) indicated standard broadcast activity (NBNS, ARP, LLMNR) originating from 192.168.134.128. The payload failed to execute its primary HTTP GET request to its hardcoded killswitch domain because the rapid system failure and Safe Mode reboot killed the network thread.